



Vikram landed hard

New NASA images of Vikram Lander's targeted landing site were released with the lander to be found nowhere. <https://digit.in/oct19-79>



Human kidney map

The first atlas of the human kidney's immune system has been created to reveal how kidney immune cells develop. <https://digit.in/oct19-80>

Samsung Galaxy Note 10+

Big things come in big packages

Two weeks into using the Galaxy Note 10+, it's easy to see why people fawn over the flagship series so much. Samsung has heaped a lot of new features on it. But is it really transformative? Let's find out –

Design and display

The Galaxy Note 10+ takes after the S-series with the Aura colours. You see a new colour on the back of the phone at every different angle. Certainly quite premium. The Note 10+ is housed in the same sturdy aluminium frame like the S10+ with glass sandwiching on both sides. It's reinforced with Gorilla Glass 6 and it's IP68 water and dust resistant.

From the right corner, the single front camera is now drilled bang into the center. The 3.5mm headphone jack port is now history with the Galaxy Note 10+.

The Galaxy Note series' display used to be one for everyone to beat. But this time around, the peak brightness we got from the Note 10+ under the sun was 635 lux, much lower than the 742 lux the OnePlus 7 Pro achieves. Yet, the AMOLED panel is HDR10+ rated and has QHD+ resolution. This alone makes objects in the display appear super sharp and crisp with excellent contrasts.

Performance

The new Exynos 9825 is based on the new 7nm EUV manufacturing process. Performance wise, only the mid-core in the SoC now has a slightly higher clock speed, but then again, Samsung also downclocked the efficiency core from 1.95GHz to 1.9GHz.

In the real world, the Galaxy Note 10+ is a charm to use. It's visibly faster than the Samsung Galaxy S10, which could primarily be because of the UFS 3.0 storage and 12GB RAM module that always keeps around 5 GB RAM free.



Price
₹19,999



DESIGN.....	88
FEATURES.....	81
PERFORMANCE.....	87
VALUE.....	85

There's an anomaly, however. We noticed that OneUI's resource management is too aggressive. It tends to kill most of the background apps if they are running for long.

Gaming on the Samsung Galaxy Note 10+ is a delight, unless you are chasing the highest frame-rates. The screen is gorgeous and

expansive enough to give a lot of hand-space, but the frame rates we clocked on PUBG Mobile and Asphalt 9 using Gamebench were much lower than what we saw on the OnePlus 7 Pro. Impressively, the phone hardly got warm during the sessions. A gripe we have is with the S-Pen. Presently, the air gestures are a bit rusty.

Battery Life

Now that Samsung has switched to the latest 7nm EUV lithography process, we were promised better power efficiency. There is a boost in screen-on time and the screen-on time has increased by an hour or so. We clocked 7 hours 16 minutes on Geekbench Battery life.

Camera

You thought the Galaxy S10+ 's camera was overkill? The Note 10+ goes a step

further and incorporates a ToF 3D camera along with the wide, ultrawide and telephoto lenses. Samsung has tuned the software so the images come out a lot better. There's a dedicated night mode and live focus in video.

The Note 10+ improves on the colours, sharpness and details, compared to the S10+. It's still essentially the same hardware insides so there's a good chance even the Galaxy S10+ might get the new software trickery eventually.

The new night mode, a first for Samsung, works quite well in enhancing low-light photos. Don't try to pixel-peep though, because that's when the photos start losing details.

The Live Focus video, however, is a little patchy. It's supposed to keep the camera focused on a (moving) subject but it keeps switching focus from the foreground to the background, resulting in a messed up bokeh video.

Verdict

The Samsung Galaxy Note 10+ comes across as a phone very similar to the Galaxy S10+, save for a few new features. There's a lot of reason for old Note users to upgrade to this one. Then there's the smaller Galaxy Note as well which comes with watered-down features including a smaller display and form factor which might find acceptance among a new breed of power users eager to get the Galaxy Note experience. What I really liked about the phone is the improved camera performance, especially in low-light, and the new DeX mode that now works much better than before. Overall, the Galaxy Note 10+ feels like an incremental upgrade, but good enough for old Note users to get a new one.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.30-inch (1080x2280) | PROCESSOR: Samsung Exynos 9825 | FRONT CAMERA: 10MP | REAR CAMERA: 12MP + 16MP + 12MP | RAM: 8GB | STORAGE: 256GB | BATTERY CAPACITY: 3500mAh | OS: Android 9 Pie

CONTACT

SAMSUNG INDIA | PHONE: 1800 40 7267864 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <https://www.samsung.com/in/>